CHAPTER 6

THE HURRIAN LANGUAGE AS A LIKELY CANDIDATE: HISTORY

In discussing which language(s) or idiom(s) might be compared in the first instance we must keep in mind Y. Duhoux's observations with regard to the agglutinative features of the idiom written with Linear A, as well as the advice given by M. Pope and J. Raison that the language which is proposed as a candidate can legitimately be supposed to have been spoken in Crete in the middle of the second millennium B.C., possibly already from the beginning of the Middle-Minoan period, when the first Minoan palaces were built, until the end of Late-Minoan IB (with *flora style* pottery) dating the layers of burnt debris, in which the bulk of Linear A tablets was found. This means that we must not only consider the phonology, morphology and syntax of the candidate idiom, but also the chronological, historical, geographical, religious, social and military position of the speakers of the idiom that is to be compared. The latter considerations can, as I have argued before, never substitute a proper linguistic analysis, since arguments on the basis of phonological, morphological and syntactical observations should be our primary concern. On the other hand, it seems sensible not to lose sight of the historical perspectives and of other aspects just mentioned.

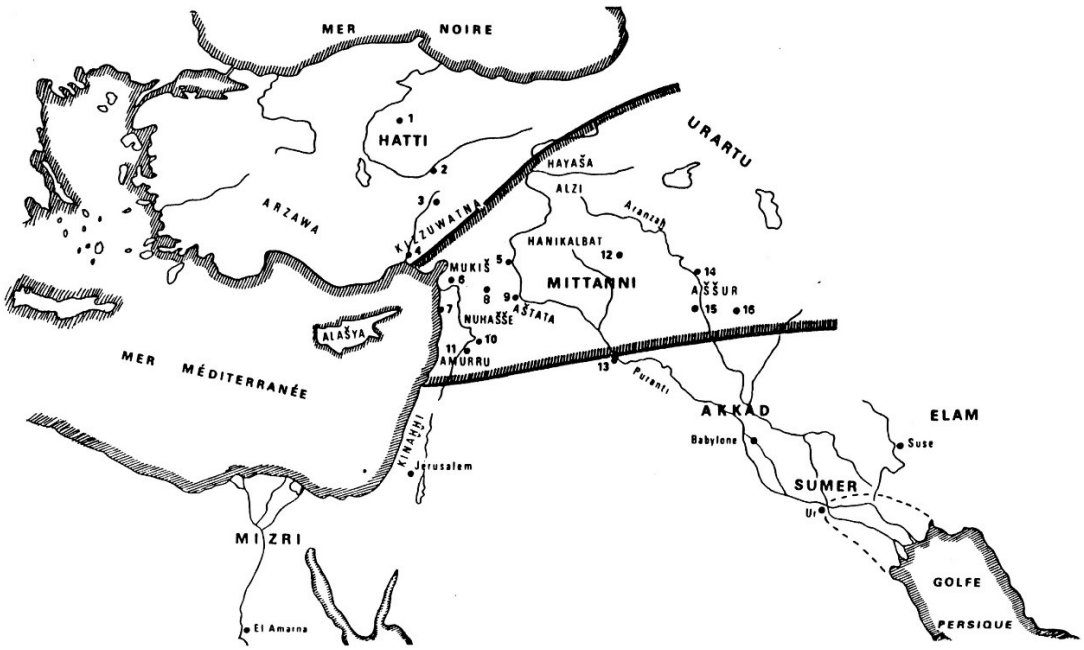
The Hurrians of the 2nd millennium B.C. are the only people who - living in a relatively close range of Crete and having built up one of the big powers in the Near East in the kingdom of Mitanni - spoke and wrote an agglutinative language of which our knowledge is still growing. Their influence was not limited to Mitanni. They had expanded into Asia Minor, especially into *Kizzuwatna* (*Cilicia*). During the 13th century political events at *Ḫattuša*, and in fact in the Hittite empire, led to the introduction of a 'provincial' religion in the Hurrian language from the Kizzuwatnian area right into the heart of Hatti. E. Laroche (*Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, 18-19): "La littérature qui l'exprime est caractérisée par des termes techniques d'origine hourrite et syrienne; l'accord avec les sources ougaritiques le prouve clairement. Le scribe anatolien s'efforce de naturaliser ces termes. I1 n'y parvient qu'à demi. Ce qui est arrivé avec le louvite, langue provinciale d'Anatolie, se produit, parallèlement, avec le hourrite: on voit naître une littérature mixte, de langue hittite, imprégnée d'une masse lexicale étrangère. On la dénomme hourro-hittite; elle se présente sous un vêtement grammatical peu correct (morphologie flottante, syntaxe relâchée), et les dictionnaires du hittite l'incorporent au vocabulaire général, ainsi que les assyriologues le font du 'nouzien'. Par leur nombre et leur variété, les documents de Boğazköy sont devenus la source première et comme le moteur de la philologie hourrite."

Recent excavations at ancient *Urkiš* (modern Tell Mozan in the North-East of Syria) have also revealed that the Kingdom of Mitanni may well have been preceded by this early Hurrian power and that Hurrian presence in north Syria, north Iraq and east Anatolia may well go back into the third millennium B.C.

Hurrian texts from Boğazköy are usually introduced by the Hittite adverb *ḫurlili* 'in a Hurrian manner' (from Hittite *ḫurla-* 'Hurrian') with which we may compare the adverb *luwili* 'in a Luwian way' which usually introduces texts written in Luwian, cf. e.g. G. Wilhelm, *Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter*, Darmstadt 1982, 2.

The Hittite adverbial forms are in *-ili* or *-umnili.* Palaic texts are introduced by the adverb *palaumnili*, Hattian texts by *ḫattili*, Akkadian 'Babylonian' texts by *pabilili* and Hittite texts by *našili, nišili* and *nešumnili* 'in the language of the town Neša', showing that 'Neshian' would have been the more proper term rather than 'Hittite' for the official language, cf. O.R. Gurney, *CAH*, Vol. II, Part 1, Chapt. VI: Anatolia *c*. 1750-1600 B.C., II. Languages and peoples, Cambridge 1978[3], 229-232.

It should be noted that Hurrian influence in Hatti did affect the religion of the Hittites and had a considerable impact upon the onomastics found in the Hittite texts, especially of members of the royal family.



After E. Laroche, *Revue hittite et asianique 34 (1976)*, 16

1.	Boğazköy	-	Ḫattuša	9.	Meskene	-	Emar
2.	Kültepe	-	Kaneš	10.	Mishrife	-	Qatna
3.	Şar	-	Kummani (Comana)	11.	Qadesh		
4.	Adana	-	Adana	12.	Chagar Bazar	-	Ašnakkum
5.	Cerablus	-	Kargamiš	13.	Tell Hariri	-	Mâri
6.	Tell Açana	-	Alalaḫ	14.	Kuyuncik	-	Ninive
7.	Ras Shamra	-	Ugarit	15.	Qal^{c}at Šerqāt	-	Aššur
8.	Aleppo	-	Ḫalba	16.	Kirkuk	-	Nuzi

The map (*supra*) is based on the one published by E. Laroche in his *Glossaire de la langue hourrite, Revue Hittite et Asianique 34 (1976)*,16, showing the area of Hurrian expansion. Important changes that I have made in the map concerns modern Chagar Bazar which is no longer identified with ancient *Šubat-Enlil*, as had been thought previously. Ph.H.J. Houwink ten Cate has kindly informed me that the latter place is now probably to be identified with modern *Leilan,* where the Americans have carried out excavations. Chagar Bazar (now called Tall Šaġīr Bāzār) is now identified with ancient Ašnakkum.

The map may in a sense be misleading, since one might *prima facie* get the impression that Hurrians were the only people living in the area marked by Hurrian expansion. One must keep in mind that the population of east Anatolia, Syria, north Iraq, Phoenicia and Palestine was of a fairly mixed composition. Even in the predominantly Hurrian areas of Mitanni itself Hurrians were not the only people. One may find there pockets and even large communities of Semitic, Kassite and sometimes Anatolian and Indo-Iranian origins as well, as is documented by the respective proper names in the archives of predominantly Hurrian *Nuzi* (modern *Kirkuk*), which was probably dependent on Mitanni.

With regard to the names of kings of the Hurrian empire of Mitanni which probably belong to an Indo-Iranian adstrate, I quote G. Wilhelm, *Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter*, 25: "Die Könige des im 16. Jahrhundert entstehenden hurritischen Grossreich - in der Folgezeit Maittani, später Mittani genannt - tragen nämlich, soweit sie uns bisher bekannt sind, ausnahmslos nicht-hurritische Thronnamen, von denen einige sicher oder mit grosser Wahrscheinlichkeit indo-arisch zu etymologisieren sind, z.B. *Artatama* = Vedisch *ṛtá-dhāman-* 'dessen Wohnstätte das Ṛta ist', *Tušratta (Tuišeratta)* = Vedisch *tveṣá-ratha-* 'dessen Streitwagen ungestüm vordringt', *Šattiwaza* = **sāti-vāja-* 'Kampfgüter erlangend', vedisch *vāja-sāti-* 'Erlangung von Kampfgüter' (Mayrhofer 1974, 23-25)."

E. Laroche, *NH*, 190, nr. 1385: Roi du Mittanni: akk. *^{m}Tu-uš-rat-ta*, KBo I 1 Ro 2, 3, 5, etc.; 3 Ro 1, 4 = PD 2 sqq., 36 sqq.; cf. EA p. 1569. – Hourr. *^{m}Du-uš-rat-ta-a*, Mit. III 103, 107, IV 127. – Nom indo-aryen; cf. Friedrich, *RL Ass. I* 145; Mironov, *Acta Or.* 11, 187; Dumont apud O'Callaghan, *Aram Naharaim 57* N° 11; Mayrhofer, *Die Sprache 5*, 79 sq., and *Šuttarna*, cf. E. Laroche, *NH*, 168, nr. 1197: Prince mittannien: akk. *^{m}Šu-ut-tar-na*, KBo I 2 Ro 34 = *^{m}Šu-ut-ta-tar-ra,* KBo I 1 Ro 53; 3 Ro 1, 4, 10, etc. = PD 16 sq., n. 5, 36 sqq.; abs. nom. *^{m}Šu-ut-tar-na-(aš),* HT 21 + KUB VIII 80, 14 = AfO 2, 120; KUB XIX 13 II 37 = JCS 10, 111; cf. Šutatarra et EA p. 1568. – Étymologies indo-aryennes: Friedrich, *RL Ass. I* 145; Mironov *Acta Or. 11*, 189; Dumont apud O'Callaghan, *Aram Naharaim 62* N° 68. - Incidentally, *Šuttarna II* was the father of *Tušratta*.

The occurrence of Indo-Iranian or Proto-Indic throne names of rulers in Mitanni and in Hittite texts, as well as the technical terms in the horse-training texts (cf. e.g. A. Kammenhuber, *Hippologia Hethitica,* Wiesbaden 1961), would not seem to mean that there was necessarily an 'Aryan' or Indo-Iranian speaking minority within the Mitannian aristocracy. The names and terms could have been acquired by contact or in the case of names by intermarriage in northern Iran or northern Mesopotamia (cf. the borrowing of French names into English from the Middle Ages onwards). Incidentally, the term 'Indo-Aryan' seems an abortion in nomenclature, though widely used. The 'Aryas' (Sanskrit *āryas* 'noble') were the aristocracy in both early Iran and early Indic society. The linguistically correct term is 'Indo-Iranian' for names which have to be assigned to languages or dialects of the family before its differentiation into Iranian and Indic sub-families. 'Proto-Iranian' or 'Proto-Indic', respectively, if one thinks that an individual name or class of names shows special features of one of the secondary sub-families.

Both A. Kammenhuber and M. Mayrhofer have convincingly argued that the names have developed Proto-Indic features (cf. A. Kammenhuber, *Die Arier im Vorderen Orient*, Heidelberg 1968; A. Kammenhuber, 'Die Arier im Vorderen Orient und die historischen Wohnsitze der Hurriter', *Orientalia Nova Series 46 (1977),* 129-144.

A. Kammenhuber, 'Die Hurriter und das Problem der Indo-Arier', *RHA* 36 *(1978),* 85-90; M. Mayrhofer, *Die Indo-Arier im Alten Vorderasien,* Wiesbaden 1966; M. Mayrhofer, *Die Arier im Vorderen Orient - ein Mythos ?* (Sitzungsberichte der Österreichische Akademie der Wissenschaften, phil.-hist. Klasse, 294. Band, 3. Abhandlung), Vienna 1974. Reprinted in: M. Mayrhofer: *Kleine Schriften*, ed. S. Deger-Jalkotzy und R. Schmitt, Wiesbaden 1979, 48-71. See also R.A. Crossland, *Cambridge Ancient History*, Vol. I, Part 2, Chapter XXVII: Immigrants from the North, Cambridge 1971[3], 824-876).

It was King Tušratta's letter written to the Egyptian pharao Amenhotep III, father of Amenhotep IV (Achnaton), found in the El Amarna archives, that led to the decipherment of the Hurrian language. The so-called Tušratta letter, also referred to as 'Mitanni letter', was written in Hurrian and could be compared with Akkadian versions of similar letters discovered in the same archives. It is still one of the main sources for understanding and analysis of the Hurrian language, since the archives of the capital of Mitanni (earlier Maitani), *Waššukkanni* or *Uššukāni* in Hurrian and *Ḫanigalbat* in Akkadian, probably in the region of the *Ḫabur* river, have not yet been found. It is presumed that *Tell Fakhāriyyah* may be identified with *Waššukkanni*. The letter proves that, apart from the usual Akkadian letters used for diplomatic correspondence with foreign states, Hurrian was the main and official language of the state of Mitanni. The letter has been published by J. Friedrich in *Kleinasiatische Sprachdenkmäler II: Subaräische Texte, A. Der Mitannibrief, B. Churrische Texte,* Berlin 1932, 7-35.

The term 'Subarian' was used in the first years of research on Hurrian texts until E.A. Speiser had convincingly argued that 'Hurrian' was in fact a better description of the Mitannian language. The letter starts with seven lines in (Babylonian) Akkadian, in which the land of Egypt is mentioned as KUR *Mi-is-ri-i* (KUR is the Sumerogram indicating 'land'). The king of Mitanni, Tušratta himself, is mentioned as *[t]Du-u]š-ra[t-t]a* LU[GAL KUR *Mi-i-ta-an-ni* (LUGAL is the Sumerogram indicating 'king'). The rest of the text is Hurrian. Here KUR *Ḫurruḫe* 'the Hurrian land' is mentioned in various forms showing the agglutinative character of the Hurrian vernacular, e.g. in line 11: KUR *Ḫur-u̯u-u-ḫé-ni-e-u̯ə-na* and in line 14: KUR *Ḫur-ru-u-ḫé-ni-e-ḫé-u̯ə*, etc.

Hurrian penetration into northern Mesopotamia had already occurred at the time of Sargon I of Akkad (ca. 2300 B.C.). During the Third Dynasty of Ur (ca. 2100-2000 B.C.) their main centres were still concentrated to the east of the Tigris river. More than half of the names on a list of workers in the palace of Ekallatum appears to be Hurrian. The majority of the population of Šušarra on the lower Zab was Hurrian. Some chiefs of the warlike Turukkians on the slopes of the Zagros mountains, in conflict with *Ḫammu-rapi* himself, had Hurrian names such as *Zaziya.* The Mâri texts mention Hurrian names of 4 or 5 princes in Upper Mesopotamia such as *Adalšenni* of Burundum (cf. A. Finet, 'Adalšenni, roi de Burundum', *Revue d'Assyriologie 60 (1966)*, 17-28) and *Šukru-tešub* of Elaḫut. At Chagar Bazar [Tall Šaġīr Bāzār = ancient Ašnakkum] Hurrians constituted a little less than a third of the population (J.R. Kupper, *CAH* Vol II, Part 1, Chapter 1: Northern Mesopotamia and Syria, IV. The Hurrians c. 1800 B.C., Cambridge 1978[3], 22).

According to G. Wilhelm (*Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter*, 1982, 12-16) the kingdom of *Urkiš/Urgeš*, probably the oldest known Hurrian state (end third millennium B.C.), stretched from the *Ḫabur* valley in Upper-Mesopotamia into the area east of the Tigris.

According to texts from *Ešnunna* in north-east Mesopotamia the later Assyrian capital *Ninive* also belonged to this kingdom. Two royal inscriptions mention *Urkiš*, one from the 21st century B.C., in Akkadian, of king † *Arišen* of *Urkiš* and *Nawar*, son of *Šatar-mat*, the other, in Hurrian (the oldest Hurrian text known to date), of *Tišatal, endan* 'King' of *Urkiš* (meaning of ***en=dan*** 'King' is confirmed by correspondence with Sumerian LUGAL. *Urkiš* is mentioned a few times in the Old Babylonian Mâri texts and presumably in an itinerarium from that period. In texts from Boğazköy *Urkiš* is mentioned as cult place of *Kumarbi*. The inscription of *Tišatal* was according to G. Wilhelm probably found at modern Tell ᶜAmūda on the Turkish-Syrian border, so that this site was in the 1980s still identified with it.

This view has changed drastically. Giorgio Buccellati and his wife Marilyn Kelly-Buccellati have led an excavation campaign of more than 20 years at Tell Mozan showing that *Urkiš* is located at Tell Mozan in northeast Syria. Their results push Hurrian presence in Syria many centuries back, proving that Urkiš was already a Hurrian religious and political centre at the end of the third / beginning of the 2nd millennium B.C. and that Hurrians in north Syria, north Iraq and east Turkey may have been as autochthonous as the Sumerians in south Iraq. †*Arišen* is now read as *Atal-šen* {*Adal-šen*} 'The brother is strong'.

I shall first discuss the views of former generations of scholars. F.W. Bush wrote in 1964 about the inscriptions (*GHL*, 281-283):

"The evidence is as follows: the Foundation Lion Inscription immediately brings to mind the so-called Samarra tablet published by Thureau-Dangin in 'Tablette de Samarra', *RA 9 (1912)*, 1-4. This tablet, acquired from an antiquities dealer in Samarra on the Tigris River between the Lower Zab and the Diyala, commemorates the dedication of a temple to the god Nergal of Hawilum by *Arišen,* son of *Šadarmat*, king of *Urkiš* and *Nawar*. The name of the scribe is *Šaum-šen*. Before the discovery of the Foundation Lion Inscription these were almost the only clearly Hurrian names from *circa* the Akkad period which occur in contemporary documents of the period. Since the tablet was purchased in Samarra, *Urkiš* and *Nawar* were placed in this region. However, by the time the Foundation Lion came to light, *Urkiš* had appeared in the Mari letters and the texts from Chagar Bazar in connection with localities that suggested the general area of the Ḫabur triangle as the region where it might be located.

Then, in 'An Old Babylonian Itinerary', *JCS 7 (1953)*, 57-72, A. Goetze published the itinerary of a journey from southern Babylonia up the Tigris past *Aššur*, across northern Mesopotamia to somewhere in Anatolia and return. In crossing the headwaters of the Ḫabur, between *Ḫarran* and *Šubat-Enlil*, *Urkiš* is mentioned as lying between stations such that it must be placed near the Ḫabur river, north of the main tributary, the Jâg-Jâg. Now this is the heart of the territory which later formed the kingdom of Mittanni.

Recently, another very suggestive detail has come to light. In 'Documents du Ḫabur ... 2. Le sceau de *Daguna*', *Syria 37 (1960)*, 209-214, Nougayrol has published a cylinder seal, executed in lapis lazuli, so inordinately fine in its workmanship that certain details appear better than in representations on a much larger scale. The scene represented is a classic 'presentation' scene in which a seated goddess, welcomes with a gesture a cortege which approaches from the right, led by another deity who announced the female supplicant by the words of the appended inscription. The accompanying inscription reads '*Daguna*, the wet-nurse, daughter of *Tiša-dimmuzi*, the royal stewardess'.

The name *Daguna* cannot be connected with certainty to any known ethnic or linguistic group [however, it is suggestive that *da-gu-na* occurs immediately before the likely Hurrian name *da-ku-se-né* (i.e. *Takku-Šenni*) in a list of personal names from the Linear A tablets from Hagia Triada on Crete (text No. 103)]. However, the name of the mother of *Daguna* is transparently Hurrian, formed from the well attested root *tiš-* and a variant form of the god *Tammuz*. That *Tammuz* had been adopted into the Hurrian pantheon is now seen from the Ug. Quad. Voc. 137 3:33, 4:18, where [*D*]*u-mu-z*[*i*] = ^{d}DUMU.[ZI], see Laroche, *Ugaritica V*, I § 27a. Laroche also refers to the form *dummuzzi* at Boğazköy. Regarding the significance of the presentation of a wet-nurse to a goddess, Nougayrol concludes very plausibly that the goddess, seated on a mountain peak, is not just any mountain goddess, but *the* mountain goddess par excellence, the eminent *Ninḫursag*, mother of the gods and the one who nurses royalty with the milk of legitimacy."

All these king's names are Hurrian and can be compared with Hurrian names from Nuzi. The 'old reading' of the personal name †*Arišen*, could be analysed as {*ar=i=šen*} 'Give the brother (oh *numen*) !' or 'Give (the child), oh (deceased) brother !'. The first element consists of the verbal root *ar-* 'to give', known from the Tušratta letter. The translation 'give', was first proposed by L. Messerschmidt, *Mitanni-Studien, Mitteilungen der Vorderasiatischen Gesellschaft 4.4*, Berlin 1899, 18f., 123. It was confirmed by association of Hurrian *ar-* with Urartian *aru* 'give' by Joh. Friedrich, 'Einführung ins Urartäische', *Mitteilungen der Vorderasiatisch-Ägyptischen Gesellschaft 37.3 (1933)*, Leipzig 1933, 51. Cf. also Ch.-F. Jean, '*Arišen* dans les lettres de Mari', *Semitica 1 (1948)*, 17-24. The second element *-šen* can be equated with *šena* 'brother' in the Tušratta letter and the common onomastic element *-šenni* < *-šen(a)=ni* 'the brother', with the suffix *-ni* for the so-called singular definite article (cf. *NPN*, 255, s.v. *šen*).

P.M. Purves had already observed that the element *ari* in Nuzi names can often be corrected to *atal*, phonologically /*adal*/, on the basis of *scriptio plena*. The old reading of †*Ari-šen* has now been corrected to *Atal-šen* 'Strong is the brother', 'The brother is the strong one', cf. I. Wegner, *Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, Wiesbaden 2007^{2}, 23.

The inscription reads (according to G. Wilhelm, *Xenia 21*, 1988, 47): "For Nerigal, for the King of Ḫawalum, *Atal-šen*, the capable shepherd ?, the King of Urkeš and Nawar, the son of King *Šatar-mat*, the builder of the temple of Nerigal, the destroyer of (his) rivals. The one who destroys this tablet, *Šamaš* and *Ištar* may 'pick up' his seed. *Šaum-šen* (has) created / is the creator of …".

About *Šatar-* in *Šatar-mat* P.M. Purves (*NPN*, 252) remarks, s.v. *šatar* (1): Hurrian formed on *šat* ? Cf. p.n. *Sá-dar-ma-at* from Samarra tablet, published by Thureau-Dangin in *RA IX*, 1-4, which in Nuzi dialect of Hurrian would be **Šatar-mati.* A personal name at Nuzi with the same element *šatar* is ^{f}*šatar-elli* (wr. ^{f}*Ša-ta-re-el-li*), cf. *NPN*, 252.

The *Tiš-atal* inscription (AO 19938) from Urkeš is the oldest Hurrian inscription. The name *Tiš-atal* (wr. *ti-iš-a-tal*) would now probably be analysed as {*ti=e=ž-adal*}, 'May the strong one speak / pronounce names', cf. ^{f}*Tieš-Naje* at Mari, analysis {*ti=e=ž-Naje*}, 'May *Naje* pronounce names', cf. Th. Richter, *VHN*, 310, 534-535, s.v. ***te-/ti-*** 'to speak'. The inscription will later be discussed more extensively.

J.R. Kupper (*CAH* Vol II, Part 1, 24) mentions that forceful Amorite migration from the south was meeting similar Hurrian immigration from the north-east, as Hurrians moved down in ever-increasing numbers from the mountainous border of the Fertile Crescent.

So some cities might have been strongly Amorite or Amorite-ruled (such as Mâri), while others close to them were strongly Hurrian. The ethnic boundary seems to have run east to west just north of Mâri. Kupper compares the demographic position of Qatna with that of Mâri, but I am not entirely convinced that Qatna (not far from Qadeš on the Orontes river and south of Alalaḫ) can be compared with Mâri in that respect. The Old Babylonian city of Mâri, trading centre on the Middle Euphrates with the palace of Zimri-Lim (cf. for its groundplan A. Moortgat, *The Art of Ancient Mesopotamia*, London - New York 1969, 79, fig. 57) was predominantly Amorite, but had a considerable Hurrian community as well, as may be inferred from the large quantity of Hurrian onomastics discovered in its archives (see J.M. Sasson, 'Ḫurrians and Ḫurrian names in the Mari texts', *UF 6 (1974)*, 353-400). Evidence from the Mâri archives is important, since it concerns the earliest attestations of Hurrian presence in Syria before the excavation of Urkiš / Tell Mozan. A few religious texts written in Hurrian have been discovered in Zimri-Lim's palace and a fragment of a letter shows that Hurrian was understood in his chancellery (cf. J.R. Kupper, *ibidem*, 22-24). The new evidence from Urkiš may change the view on the whole process: It now seems more likely that in north Syria and in particular in the Ḫabur area of north Mesopotamia Amorites moved into former Hurrian territory, not vice versa.

Records from the 16th and 15th century B.C. at *Nuzi* (modern *Yorgan Tepe* near modern Kurdish *Kirkuk*) in the Kingdom of *Arrapḫa* show that this city was predominantly Hurrian. Arrapḫa was reigned by Hurrian kings with Hurrian names such as *Itḫi-teš(š)ub* / *Itḫiḫa*. Its archives provide to date the largest source of Hurrian personal names, cf. I.J. Gelb - P.M. Purves - A.A. MacRae, *Nuzi Personal Names* (*The University of Chicago, Oriental Institute Publications* 57), Chicago 1943.

The name of *Itḫi-teš(š)ub* is mentioned by Gelb, *NPN*, 76: *It-ḫi-te-eš-šu-up*, variant *It-ḫi-te-šup*: *šarr* ^{l}*Ar-ra-ap-ḫi*, son of *Ki-bi-te-eš-šu-up*, HSS X 231:1; SMN 1003; 1466; *šarr* ^{l}*Ar-ra-ap-ḫi*, son of *Ki-bi-te-eš-šu-up* and *Ki-ip-te-šup*. etc. Gelb refers to the name *Itḫiḫa*, since he is not only called *It-ḫi-ia* (variant *Ut-ḫi-ia*) *šarr* ^{l}*Ar-ra-ap-ḫi* 'King of *Arrapḫa*', but also son of *Ki-bi-te-*[*eš*]*-šu-up*, SMN 1453. One may infer that *Itḫiḫa* and *Itḫi-teš(š)ub* are one and the same king, since they are the son of apparently the same father. *Itḫiḫa* is a hypocoristic name and *-ya* is the current hypocoristic suffix in Hurrian.

The demographic position of north Syrian *Alalaḫ* is of particular interest, since we can observe a considerable increase of the Hurrian population in that city on the basis of the proportion of Hurrian names discovered in the archives of two historically distinct levels. The proportion of Hurrian names constituted approximately 50 % in the archives of Level VII (of which the end can be dated to ca. 1640 B.C.) and increased to ca. 75 % in those of Level IV (beginning ca. 1490 B.C.) as is shown by A. Draffkorn (later: A. Kilmer), *Hurrians and Hurrian at Alalaḫ: an ethno-linguistic analysis,* dissertation in Oriental Studies, Univ. of Pennsylvania 1959, 17; 117-118. The large quantity of Hurrian proper names at Alalaḫ, already present in the texts from Alalaḫ VII, may well plead for the arrival of substantial groups of Hurrians at the north Syrian coast in an earlier period than is often assumed.

It is clear that before the excavation of Urkiš / Tell Mozan G. Wilhelm (*Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter*, 22) could still write in 1982 (I translate the German text): "It is hard to tell how far west of the Euphrates the elements of Hurrian population and their cultural, especially their religious legacy, had already penetrated in the Mari-period. At any rate in spite of continuation of the tradition of Amorite throne-names Ḫalab and Alalaḫ display a Hurrian identity in the following period until about 1560, not only in onomastics (Draffkorn 1959), but also in the pantheon (Landsberger 1954: 64) and ritual terminology (Haas/Wilhelm, 1974: 138f.). When Landsberger (1954: 64) speaks – with regard to Ḫalab, Uršum, Ḫaššum and Karkemiš – right away about the four Hurrian kingdoms west of the Euphrates, this is presumably basically a correct description of the situation, possibly with the exception of Karkemiš. Since – as far as we can see – the development of this period (ca. 1695-1560) shows signs of continuity, one tends to extrapolate the situation at Ḫalab, Alalaḫ and Ḫaššum of the 16th century into the 17th century B.C.. This remains, however, as uncertain as the conclusion based on the absence of incontestable sources, that in the Mari-period immigation of Hurrians had not yet taken place in the area between the Euphrates and Mediterranean Sea (Kammenhuber 1977). Apart from the essentially earlier texts from Ebla there are no written sources offering a certain *terminus post quem* for immigration of Hurrian into North-Syria."

Once again, early presence of Hurrians in north Syria at Urkiš / Tell Mozan seems to emphasize that the 50 % of Hurrian names in Level VII at Alalaḫ may represent the original indigenous population of the area, whereas the Amorite names including the throne-names may indicate the arrival of Amorite newcomers. The increase of Hurrian names upto 75 % in Level IV at Alalaḫ may be the result of growing power of Mitanni.

Regarding the chronology of events at Alalaḫ in relation to developments in other areas I present the reconstruction proposed by A. Draffkorn, *HHA*,13-17: "For the length of Alalaḫ VII in terms of absolute figures, no exact data are available. One assumes, at the least, four generations and six rulers for Yamḫad; to consider two further generations, represented by Yarim-Lim III and Ḫammu-rapi II, is to impose inordinately long reigns upon their two contemporaries in Alalaḫ. Therefore, to have them logically coincidental, we must presuppose a possible fraternal relationship between Irkabtum of Yamḫad and Yarim-Lim III. Another argument in favor of a span of four generations is that we cannot be dealing with much more than ca. 110 years. We know from Hittite evidence that Alalaḫ VII was destroyed by Ḫattušiliš I in ca. 1640 (according to the middle chronology), or somewhat less than fifty years before the raid on Babylon by Muršiliš I, grandson of Ḫattušiliš. This leaves ca. 110 years between the destruction and the approximate beginning of Samsu-iluna's reign (ca. 1750). The period, then, that the OB texts cover is later than that of Ḫammu-rapi of Babylon and the Mâri archives (contemporary with Yarim-Lim I and Ḫammu-rapi I of Yamḫad, who are not directly concerned in the Alalaḫ documents). It was indicated earlier that, although Hurrians were by no means strangers to Mâri, they enjoyed there no such prominence as at Alalaḫ VII. Two possible explanations of this disparity suggest themselves readily:

(a) Alalaḫ lay in one of the direct paths of Hurrian penetration, whereas Mâri was only marginally affected. (b) the migration affected Mâri as much as Alalaḫ, but at a somewhat later period, for which we have no Mâri documentation.

The first alternative appears to be preferable. The years following the end of Alalaḫ VII must have witnessed a further and widespread incursion of Hurrians, coming in the wake of the migrations of the 'Dark Age'. Such an incursion is perhaps reflected in the Hurrian attack on the caravan of Muršiliš I, as he was returning from his raid on Babylon, and also apparently in the Hurrian invasion against the Hittites under Muršiliš's successor, Ḫantilis I. This invasion caused great upheaval in the Hittite kingdom and may even have been partly responsible for the destruction of Ḫattuša (cf. A. Götze, *JCS 11,* 55, 61). The number of years in the intervening period can only be roughly estimated, since we do not know exactly when level IV of Alalaḫ began. We do know that MB Alalaḫ flourished during the mid-fifteenth century under Niqm-epa, a contemporary of his suzerain, Saussatar (or rather Saussatatar) of Mitanni.

Two kings of Alalaḫ, Ilimi-limma I and Idrimi, preceded the reign of Niqm-epa; if we assign to them about fifty years, the time span between VII (end ca. 1640) and IV (beginning ca. 1490) would have been of the order of 150 years, or somewhat less (cf. B. Landsberger, *JCS 8*, 115 ff; A. Götze, *JCS 11*, 71). A century and a half would have allowed ample time for newly arrived Hurrians to settle in Alalaḫ and elsewhere, and to have established themselves as a political entity for the first time in the kingdom of Mitanni. That they also made their way into southern Syria and Palestine is attested in a number of ways (notably the Hurrian personal names from Tell Ta'annak, cf. W.P. Albright, *BASOR 94,* 12-27; B. Landsberger, *JCS 8,* 59), but the date of their arrival remains uncertain. If the story of Dinah (Gen. 34) contains an historical kernel, and if the equation of Shechemites (cf. E.A. Speiser, *JWH 1/2,* 322 f.; *AASOR 13,* 26 f.) with Horites/Hurrians is valid - as it appears to be - the presence of Hurrians in Palestine might date back to the later patriarchal period.

In any case, during the Amarna age *Ḫuru* came to be the Egyptian designation for Palestine and thus a further example of the southerly expansion of the Hurrians (cf. E.A. Speiser, *AASOR 13*, 27 and note 54). As a result of the Hurrian flowering in northern Syria, Anatolia, and northern Mesopotamia in the mid-second millennium, MB Alalaḫ reveals a considerable increase of Hurrians in what was earlier a predominantly West Semitic population."

It seems very likely that A. Draffkorn rightly assumes that Hurrian advance into northern Syria must have taken place a considerable time before the first recorded destruction of Alalaḫ by Ḫattušiliš I in ca. 1640 B.C. (according to the middle chronology), since the archives of Alalaḫ VII show that 50 % of its population consisted of Hurrians. Was it 110 years before 1640 B.C. as she proposes ? Her hypothesis seems to be on the safe side. Since an *argumentum ex silentio* works both ways, it was impossible to tell at the time A. Draffkorn wrote her thesis, whether 1750 B.C. was a reasonable date for Hurrian penetration into northern Syria. She preferred the option that Hurrian expansion into Syria took a path from northern Mesopotamia to the south-west in fact following the curve of the Fertile Crescent and leaving Mâri largely aside.

Since Mâri was lying more eastward, it was in her view only marginally affected, whereas the centres of Aleppo (*Ḫalab* in West Semitic and *Ḫalba* in Hurrian), Alalaḫ, Ḫaššu(m), Uršu(m), and Karkemiš west of the Euphrates seem strongly affected. Ḫaššu(m) and Uršu(m) were situated to the north of Aleppo between the river and the foothills prolonging Mount Casius and the Amanus.

The results of the excavations at Hurrian Urkiš / Tell Mozan in northeast Syria seem to corroborate the view that the entire North of Syria from Urkiš to the Mediterranean, including the area of Alalaḫ and Aleppo, may already have been Hurrian in a very early stage.

In that case there must have been a boundary somewhere between the Eblaite area and the territories of Alalaḫ and Aleppo during the early period. Aleppo, first under the name Yamḫad, poses the most difficult problem, because there is virtually no direct contemporary documentary evidence. It was clearly a most important - perhaps the leading - state in north Syria. Its rulers in the 16th and early 15th century B.C. had still West Semitic names, but that may be due to a tradition of throne-names (compare the traditions at Ugarit and Alalaḫ).

The Hittite texts which deal with the operations of Ḫattušiliš I and Muršiliš I do not mention explicitly that it was Hurrian. The texts are: H.G. Güterbock, 'Die historische Tradition und ihre literarische Gestaltung bei Babyloniern und Hethitern bis 1200. Zweiter Teil: Hethiter', *Zeitschrift für Assyriologie 44 (1938), NF 10*, 45-149 (with the Akkadian text on the 'Siege of Uršum', 78-84, text Ankara Museum, 201-203); H. Otten, 'Keilschrifttexte (der Kampagne 1957 in Boğazköy)', *Mitteilungen der Deutschen Orient-Gesellschaft 91 (1958)*, 73-84 ('Annals of Ḫattušiliš I', 78 ff.). O.R. Gurney, *Cambridge Ancient History*, Vol. II, Part 1, Chapter VI, Anatolia c. 1750-1600 B.C., IV. The Old Hittite Kingdom, Cambridge 1978[3], 235-251, discusses the 'Annals of Ḫattušiliš' on pages 236-238 and 241-246.

I quote Gurney's translation of the record of the second year of Ḫattušiliš's reign on the campaign against Alalaḫ (p. 241) [I use *ḫ* and *š* instead of Gurney's *kh* and *sh*]:

"*In the next year I marched against Alḫalḫa* (var. *Alalḫa*) *and destroyed it. Afterwards I marched against Uršu* (var. *Waršuwa*)*; from Uršu I marched against Igakališ; from Igakališ I marched against Tašḫinya* (var. *Tišḫiniya*). *On my way back I destroyed the land of Uršu and filled my house with treasures*."

As O. Gurney concludes, *Alḫalḫa* / *Alalḫa* can hardly be anything than the city of *Alalaḫ*. I may add: it may well be the Hurrian-Hittite rendering of the West Semitic name *Alalaḫ* (compare the pattern with metathesis of *Ḫalab* : *Ḫalba* and *Alalaḫ* : *Alḫalḫa* /*Alalḫa*). O. Gurney mentions that it is not only remarkable that this campaign into Syria was undertaken at the very beginning of Ḫattušiliš's reign, but also that no preliminary operations were mentioned, so that we must conclude that the Taurus mountains with the Cilician Gates were already under his control including the land of Adaniya (modern Adana), Kizzuwatna (Cilicia), which explains why Alalaḫ came to be the first Syrian city to succumb to Ḫattušiliš I.

Ḫattušiliš's silence about any interference from the king of Aleppo to come to the aid of his vassal Alalaḫ can be explained, if Ḫattušiliš had seized the opportunity provided by a dynastic dispute at Aleppo, as a result of which Ammitaqum of Alalaḫ had assumed his independence and was unable to call on the assistance of his former overlord (cf. for the details Gurney, *ibidem*, 241-242). If this reconstruction is correct, Ḫattušiliš was not only a capable general, but also a very cunning politician.

The next year Ḫattušiliš had to break off his campaign against Arzawa in western Anatolia, because his own kingdom was invaded in the rear by a power called '*Ḫanigalbat*' in the Akkadian and '*the Hurrians*' in the Hittite version. The whole country fell to them with the exception of *Ḫattuša* itself.

Here again we have the earliest reference in Hittite history to a nation later to exercise a powerful influence on the civilization of Anatolia. [...] But the population of North Syria had also for some time been predominantly Hurrian, and the sequel suggests that the North Syrian kingdoms had a part in the invasion (cf. Gurney, *ibidem*, 242).

Ḫattušiliš continued to punish the cities in Syria and in the Euphrates area, also in the 6th year. *Ḫaššu* offered resistance and was supported by *Ḫalba* (Aleppo), which appears here for the first time. The Syrian forces were routed in the battle at Mount Adalur (associated with the Amanus). Ḫattušiliš crossed the Euphrates and destroyed *Ḫaššu*. [...] The reign of Ḫattušiliš was dominated by his Syrian wars and the kingdom of Yamḫad was his real opponent. A later treaty mentions: *In former days the kings of Aleppo possessed a great kingdom; Ḫattušiliš caused (the days of) their kingdom to be full, but Muršiliš destroyed it* (cf. Gurney, *ibidem*, 243). According to Gurney it is generally agreed that the second clause implies that Ḫattušiliš began to attack and diminish the territories of this 'great kingdom' (a status not yet claimed by the Hittites themselves). He must, however, have met with a reverse, perhaps even received a mortal injury, for which his grandson who became his adopted son and successor, Muršiliš I, took revenge (*ibidem*, 244).

O. Gurney mentions fragments of a Hittite legend about these Syrian wars providing a link with the history of Alalaḫ and Aleppo. It is about a general of the king of Aleppo, *Zukraši*, who is recorded as a witness on a document from Alalaḫ by which *Ammitaqum* of Alalaḫ declared his will before his suzerain, *Iarimlim* (III) of Aleppo. In the Hittite text this general, together with a leader of the *Umman Manda*, brings troops to the aid of the king of *Ḫaššu* in his resistance to the Hittite king. In another fragment, probably of the same text, *Iarimlim* and his son *Ḫammurabi* of Aleppo are mentioned. Since *Zukraši* still holds the position which he held in the reign of *Ammitaqum*, the date of the campaign of Ḫattušiliš cannot be too far removed from the downfall of *Ammitaqum* of Alalaḫ. The texts probably describe events in Ḫattušiliš's campaign against *Ḫaššu* in the 6th year of his reign, four years after Alalaḫ was destroyed (cf. O. Gurney, *ibidem*, 244-245).

O. Gurney does not mention that *Zukraši*, general of the king of Aleppo, had a Hurrian name, also attested in the Alalaḫ texts of layer VII (ca. 1640 B.C.). A. Draffkorn, *HHA*, 147, mentions **Zu-uk-ra-si* [A. Draffkorn marks texts belonging to Alalaḫ VII with *]:
(1) UGULA.AGA.UŠ, br. *Pendam-muzuni*, br. ^{f}*Aya-aḫati* *6:27; *23:9. -
(2) LÚ IŠ *252:18; *253:10; *254:8; *256:23; *264:6; *274:13; *283b:7. - (3) *325:3.

A. Draffkorn comments: "If Hurrian, perhaps connect with the element *šugri-*. For a discussion of (1) and his appearance in a Bogh. text, see Landsberger, *JCS 8*, 52."

There is no reason for A. Draffkorn's cautiousness concerning the Hurrian identity of the name, for her next entry in *HHA*, 147, **Zu-uk-ri-ya* (LÚ GU.ZA.LÁ *409:33) no doubt contains the same element with the hypocoristic element *-ya,* and can be equated with the names in the list of 87 persons from Nuzi, called *Šukriia* (written *Šuk-ri-ia, Šu-uk-ri-ia, Šuk-ri-a*), which is probably a hypocoristic of names such as *Šukri-tešup*, cf. I.J. Gelb - P.M. Purves - A.A. MacRae, *NPN,* 136-137. The verbal root ***šugr-*** probably means 'to protect / to bless', cf. Th. Richter, *BGH*, 409. I consider it likely that the name ***Zukraši*** is equivalent to an abstract form in ***-(a)=šše***, ***zukraši*** {*šugr=a=šše*}, probably 'blessing'. Consequently the name of the general is 'Blessing'.

Although the kings of Aleppo and those of Alalaḫ kept Amorite throne-names, the Hurrian name of a general at Aleppo confirms that Hurrians held the highest positions at Aleppo. It is likely that the demographic position of Aleppo was fairly similar to that of Alalaḫ, since its geographic position was even closer to the centres of Hurrian power in north Mesopotamia which constituted the 'Great Kingdom of Mitanni', which became in the 16th - 15th centuries the strongest power in the Near East next to Egypt, sending its princesses to the Pharaoh's court, until Suppiluliuma I turned it into a vassal state.

Excavation of the royal archives of Aleppo might well yield the most needed evidence regarding the exact demographic position of the city. Actually the horrors of civil war have turned the city of Aleppo into ruins unimaginable for a man like Muršiliš. Apart from the loss of human lives, who knows what damage modern warefare causes for the antiquities still hidden under the soil ? Maybe, if this horror comes to an end, one could make an effort, in the process of rebuilding the city, to excavate the areas where the ancient palace is suspected to be situated.

Considering plausible scenario's of the demographic developments in north-west Syria and Kizzuwatna (Cilicia) - in the absence of hard contemporary documentary evidence for some crucial sites - the most likely scenario seems to be that Hurrians may have been autochthonous in north-west Syria as they were in the north-east (Urkiš), possibly already from the second half of the 3rd millennium B.C.. The second best scenario is that they moved around 2000 B.C. in large numbers from the *Ḫabur* area along the routes of the Fertile Crescent into north-west Syria and Kizzuwatna with its obsidian- and silvermines. In the first case they met up with early Canaanites in the Eblaite area in west Syria, in the second case they may have had to face the arrival of West Semitic Amorites in north-west Syria and may have encountered a Luwian population in Kizzuwatna.

To judge by ritual texts attributed to Kizzuwatnans and found at Boğazköy a large Hurrian element was at the latest present in Kizzuwatna by the 14th century among a Luwian-speaking population. These Hurrians may well have been indigenous or may have arrived long before, but we do not know how long before. It is also suspected that the evidence of Hurrian personal names within the royal family of the Hittite Empire may be due to their Kizzuwatnian roots. Members of the Hittite royal family and nobles intermarried with Hurrians. At the Hittite court and in the capital Hurrian influence, especially religious and cultural, was prominent from late in the 15th century B.C..

Having reached the Mediterranean coasts of Syria and Kizzuwatna the most adventurous may have chosen to seek their fortunes overseas, as traders or as buccaneers, visiting, investigating and sometimes raiding the shores of nearby Cyprus and other islands farther away such as Crete, and eventually discovering and selecting the best places to settle as soon as they considered the moment opportune to do so, if the prospects at home were no longer favourable and migration might offer a better future. If it is true that Hurrian settlers built the first Minoan palaces in Crete, they must have reached the coasts of the Mediterranean at least as early as ca. 2000 B.C..

Many reasons and motifs could lead to migration in smaller or larger groups. Expectations for a better life in general or an inspiring example in particular could trigger off a migration movement. Modern parallels are close at hand with the recent large-scale migrations of refugees from the Near East and the coasts of North Africa to Europe.

The motif is not always connected with despair. For some it may have been a challenge to build palaces as splendid as those at Urkiš, Mâri, Aleppo, Alalaḫ or Waššukkanni. To me the most likely scenario seems to be that a large-scale migration of Hurrians to Crete was instigated and led by (or on the authority of) the king of a strong political and military power such as an early king of Mitanni (or even a king of Urkiš). A legendary King *Kirta* might in that case be a good candidate.

Historical parallels of Phoenician colonisation from the end of the 9th century and Greek colonisation from the 8th century B.C. may throw light on the perspectives of people leaving their homeland. Their achievements would be great in emulation of their ancestors, in cooperation with the homeland and in adapting to what they would find.

An error commonly made is the presupposition that early seafarers were always looking for good harbours to exchange their trade. But in early seafaring the sailors followed the coasts as closely as possible, went ashore at sunset and pulled their boats onto the beach. Greek sailors, following Hesiod's advice in his *Ἔργα καὶ ἡμέραι* (Works and Days), knew that it was only during a period of 50 days (July – August) safe enough to go sailing.

Hesiod, *Ἔργα καὶ ἡμέραι*, 663 ff.: *Fifty days after the solstice, when the season of wearisome heat is come to an end, is the right time for men to go sailing. Then you will not wreck your ship, nor will the sea destroy the sailors, unless Poseidon the Earth-Shaker be set upon it, or Zeus, the king of the deathless gods, wish to slay them; for the issues of good and evil alike are with them. At that time the winds are steady, and the sea is harmless. Then trust in the winds without care, and haul your swift ship down to the sea and put all the freight on board; but make all haste you can to return home again and do not wait till the time of the new wine and autumn rain and uncoming storms with the fierce gales of Notus who accompanies the heavy autumn rain of Zeus and stirs up the sea and makes the deep dangerous.*

H.T. Wallinga (*De Griekse kolonisatie in Zuid-Italië en Sicilië* [*Greek colonisation in South-Italy and Sicily*], inaugural lecture at the University of Utrecht, 24th May 1965, Groningen 1965, 6) pointed out that in the description of Herodotus (*Histories* IV, 196) the Carthaginian trading techniques differed considerably from what we are used to: *Another story too is told by the Carchedonians. There is a place in Libya, they say, where men dwell beyond the Pillars of Heracles; to this they come and unload their cargo; then having laid it orderly along the beach they go aboard their ships and light a smoking fire. The people of the country see the smoke, and coming to the sea they lay down gold to pay for the cargo and withdraw away from the wares. Then the Carchedonians disembark and examine the gold; if it seems to them a fair price for their cargo, they take it and go their ways; but if not, they go aboard again and wait, and the people come back and add more gold till the shipmen are satisfied. Herein neither party (it is said) defrauds the other; the Carchedonians do not lay hands on the gold till it matches the value of their cargo, nor do the people touch the cargo till the shipmen have taken the gold.*

H.T. Wallinga (*ibidem*, 10-11) also explained that Phoenician trade in the time of King Salomo, ca. 950 B.C., still concentrated on obtaining luxury goods for the courts in the Near East (e.g. trade with Tarshish in south-west Spain, identical with Herodotus' Tartessos).

This kind of trade usually took three years: one year for sailing to Spain, one year for trading and one for the return. Around 850 B.C. the Assyrians threatened to conquer Syria and Phoenicia causing demand of iron, lead and tin. The kings of Sidon and Tyre could no longer afford to wait three years for the ships to return and decided to found a colony Carthage halfway between Phoenicia and Spain (possibly Etruria as well) enabling the ships to provision on their way and to shorten the journey to one year.

The Greek citizens of Chalkis on Euboea learning from the Phoenicians' success with Carthage decided to found Pithekoussai as the first Greek colony on the island of Ischia in the Bay of Napels which would make it easier for them to purchase iron in Etruria, since they had an *apoikia* of farmers, migrated from their own metropolis, to facilitate victualling.

The prominent role of Hurrians in the trade of metals through northern Mesopotamia and Syria and of obsidian and silver from Kizzuwatna may have brought them to Cyprus rich in copper and to Crete, always in need of bronze. Crete could of course sell its own agricultural products in return.

The demographic position of the area of Ugarit (modern Ras Shamra) is rather complicated. The largely Semitic texts show a majority of West Semitic (Amorite) names, but the proportion of Hurrian people was fairly high as can be inferred from their onomastics published by F. Gröndahl, *Die Personennamen der Texte aus Ugarit,* Rome 1967: Teil II: Die hurritische Namen, 203-267. As regards Ugarit E. Laroche (*Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, 19) writes: "À Ugarit, il y avait une forte population de langue hourrite, comme en témoignent l'onomastique, les vocabulaires polyglottes et les tablettes musicales."

Apart from a West Semitic and Hurrian population at Ugarit, also Hittites, Assyrians, Egyptians and Aegeans were resident, as expected in a city where commercial activities were so prominent. Already in the aftermath of the Hyksos period during the reign of great Warrior Pharaohs such as Thutmoses III, but certainly in the Amarna period (middle of the 14th century B.C.) Ugarit was an Egyptian vassal, as may be inferred from a number of letters to the pharaoh from the first kings attested in the records of *ᶜAmmiṯtamru I* and *Niqmaddu II*. Shortly after this period and after the campaigns of *Šuppiluliuma I* Ugarit became part of the Hittite empire as shown by the treaties between the Hittite kings and their vassals at Ugarit, the many juridical texts and decrees issued by the Hittite kings at Ḫattuša and the kings of Karkamiš, who were the Hittite suzerain's viceroys of Syria, often Hittite princes themselves (cf. W.H. van Soldt, 'Ugarit as a Hittite vassal state', *Altorientalische Forschungen 37 (2010)*, 199).

According to R.S. Hess ('The onomastics of Ugarit', in: W.G.E. Watson and N. Wyatt, eds., *Handbook of Ugaritic Studies*, Leiden 1999, 499-528) the texts from Ugarit contain about 10 % Anatolian names of which the majority occurs in the phrase 'son of ...' without mentioning the name of the son.

If the name of a son is mentioned, it is often a West Semitic name. Probably the persons with Anatolian names came from outside Ugarit and gave their children preferably West Semitic and sometimes Hurrian names (cf. W.H. van Soldt, *o.c.*, 206).

Van Soldt concludes that there seem to be two exceptions. Apart from the royal family, where the intended successor to the throne received traditional Amorite names and where the other family members often had Hurrian names, there are two groups who seem to have preferred Hurrian names for their children: the *šākinu* and the *šatammu*. The first one was the highest state official after the king, the second an important administrator.

In view of the changing naming habits in Syria, particularly in nearby Amurru, this may have been inspired by traditions developed in the Hittite empire (cf. Van Soldt, *ibidem*, 206). The habit may, however, also have been inherited from the period when Ugarit was a vassal of Mitanni. Apart from *Ar-ḫalba*, whose name is Hurrian, all other Ugaritic kings bore West Semitic (throne) names; 11 names of Ugarit's royal family are West Semitic: *ʾIbīrānu, IR-šarrumma* (?), *ʾAšdadā* (?), *Niqmaddu II* and *III*, *Yaqaru*, *Niqmepa*^{c}, *Nūriyānu*, ^{c}*Ammiṯtamru I* and *II* and *Pi-ṣidqi* (cf. W.H. van Soldt, 'The use of Hurrian names at Ugarit', *UF 35 (2003)*, 684-685 and n. 26-29). A brother and a son of king ^{c}*Ammiṯtamru II* bore also Hurrian names, *Ḫišmi-šarrumma* and *Utri-šarrumma* (?), as well as queen *Ṯaryelli.* Van Soldt's question mark after *Utri-šarruma* is probably due to the first element of the name, but the root ***udr-*** means 'militärischen Schutz leisten' ['to offer military protection'] in the Qaṭna-letters, cf. Th. Richter, 2005, 27 f.

F. Gröndahl (*Die Personennamen der Texte aus Ugarit, Studia Pohl 1,* Rome 1967, 250), mentions: *ut-ri-ša-ru-ma*, 1. Element unbekannt, vgl. *Utruwasu* [*NH* Nr. 1459 u. S. 320]. E. Laroche, *NH*, 200, mentions sub n° 1459 *Utruwasu*, that *Ut-ru-wa-šu* BIN IV 68, 15, is a name from Cappadocia. Laroche's reflections (*ibid.*, 320-322) on the equation of Cappadocian *-asu* with Hittite *assu* 'good', the objections by A. Kammenhuber, and Laroche's comparison with names in *-(i)ašu* from Nuzi (*NPN* 206) are interesting, but lead us too far away from the subject under discussion. The name ***Utri-šarrumma***, son of king ^{c}***Ammiṯtamru II*** of Ugarit, can now be analysed as Hurrian {*Udr=i-šarrumma*} 'Protect (the boy), oh *Šarrumma* !'. *IR-šarrumma* ranks according to Van Soldt among the members of the royal family with West Semitic names, but his name is provided with a question mark and may perhaps be ranked among those with Hurrian names, since F. Gröndahl (*PNTU,* 250) mentions him as *irṯrm* in alphabetic cuneiform.

The Hurrian-Anatolian god *Šarruma* (later *Šarma*), *ṯrm* or *ḏrm* in alphabetic cuneiform, is the son of the Hurrian gods *Ḫebat* and *Tešub* (cf. F. Gröndahl, *ibidem*, 250; E. Laroche, 'Le dieu anatolien *Šarruma*', *Syria 40 (1963)*, 277 ff.). Ph.H.J. Houwink ten Cate (*The Luwian population groups of Lycia and Cilicia Aspera during the Hellenistic period*, Leiden 1965, 134-136): "*Šar(ru)ma* is in origin a Hurrian god, the son of *Ḫepat* and *Tešub*. He is portrayed close to his parents as no. 44 at Yazılıkaya. The same group is found together at Darende. In cuneiform script his name is generally written as ^{d}LUGAL-*ma.*" After mentioning a series of Hurrian personal names with the element -*Šarruma* and -LUGAL-*ma*, Ph.H.J. Houwink ten Cate concludes: "Evidently this Hurrian god was completely assimilated in the Luwian pantheon, otherwise his name would not be linked up with *Ḫuḫa-* and *Ṵašu-*. On the other hand it must be noted that this has happened in Hieroglyphic names."

The name of the wife of King *Ar-ḫalba* is *Kubaba*. E. Laroche includes the theonym in his *GLH*, 150: Grande déesse de Karkémish introduite à Ugarit et au Kizuwatna, puis en Anatolie (*Kubêbê*). Dans les listes divines kizouvatniennes, avec *Adamma* et *Ḫašuntarḫi.*

Graphies: ^{d}*Ku-pa-pa*, KUB XXVII 1 II 53; 8 Ro 14; 13 I 19; KBo XX 113 I 23, etc., ^{d}*Ku-pa-wa$_{a}$*, KBo V 2 III 15 = 1/a 3.
Erg. *Ku-pa-pa*-[*aš*], KUB XXV 42 + V 9.
Gén. *Ku-ba-ba-be*, Msk.
Dir. *Kbb-d* = **Ku-ba-ba-da*, RS 24.261,23 = *Ugar. V,* 501, 503.

The Hurrian genitive suffix *-we/-be* and directive suffix *-d* in alphabetic cuneiform of Ugarit (= *-da* in the syllabic cuneiform) proves at any rate that the name is treated as Hurrian by the scribe. The queen's name clearly shows that the theonym can be used as a personal name. E. Laroche (*Les Noms des Hittites*, Paris 1966, 99) mentions the personal name ^{f}*Kubaba* at Boğazköy, sub n° 636, Diverses: abs. nom. ^{f}*Ku-ba-ba,* ^{f}*Ku-pa-(a)-pa-(aš)*, HT 2 III 8 = KBo II 31 Vo 12; KBo IX 142, 3; X 10 III 18; XII 62, 6, 7; fragm. KUB XXXVI 2 c 5.

Van Soldt's caution apropos of the ethnic identity of the queen's name may be based on Laroche's comment on its alleged original provenance (*NH*, 244), sub *Type VI: bases dissyllabiques à seconde syllabe redoublée*: "Le nom de *Kubaba* ressemble au type; mais n'est-il pas celui d'une déesse étrangère, syrienne, et le nom d'origine sumérienne? Il y a donc le risque que ces réduplications apparentes ne cachent en réalité soit une suffixation (*Palala* < *pal-ala*) soit une composition (*ku-baba*). L'indo-européen ignore ce patron grammatical."Although the theonym may have originated in Sumer, association with e.g. *Adamma* in Syria and Kizzuwatna proves that she was well embedded in the Hurrian pantheon. Equation of Linear A *ku-pa$_{3}$-pa$_{3}$* (HT 88.4), from Hagia Triada, read by *GORILA 1*, 138-139, with a feminine Hurrian personal name such as ^{f}*Kubaba* from Ugarit and Boğazköy or with the theonym will be discussed later.

The numbers of Hurrian names among the highest officials of Ugarit, of smaller towns, of the palace and of the queen are striking. W.H. van Soldt (The use of Hurrian names at Ugarit, *UF 35*, 2003, 687 and notes 45-46) mentions among the total of 13 governors (*šākinu - šakin māti - maškim*) 4 with West Semitic and 9 with Hurrian names, and among the administrators (*šà.tam*) 2 with West Semitic, 6 with Hurrian names and 1 unexplained. On the other hand among the scribes and the *maryannu* (*ibidem*, 687-688) there is a majority of West Semitic names as compared to the Hurrian onomastics. The *maryannu/i* are 'officers of the charioteers' in Mitanni. They form a class at Alalaḫ. The term is also attested at Ugarit and Boğazköy. Its origin is no doubt Indian *marya-* according to E. Laroche (*GLH*, 168, s.v. *maryanni*) and many others, but a non-Indo-Iranian etymology seems now possible because of Urartian *mare* 'high royal official', cf. Th. Richter, *BGH*, 244-245.

There is great merit in Van Soldt's approach not to limit his information to Ugarit, but to compare the evidence from the cities of *Karkamiš*, *Amurru*, *Siyannu* and *Ušnatu* (*ibidem*, 685-686) as well. Of these I quote the respective numbers of members of the royal families: Royal family of *Karkamiš*: West Semitic: none; Hurrian: 11; Anatolian: 7. All kings had Hurrian names: *Ḫišmi-teššub, Ḫišni, Ini-teššub, Kuzi-teššub, Šaḫurunuwa, Šarru-kušuḫ, Tabaʾe* (uncertain)*, Taki-šarrumma, Talmi-teššub, Tili-šarrumma, Tulpi-šarrumma.* Only *Šarru-kušuḫ* also had the Hittite name *Piyassili.* The princes had Hurrian and Anatolian names.
Royal family of *Amurru*: West Semitic: 6; Hurrian: 4; Anatolian: 1.
Royal families of *Siyannu* and *Ušnatu*: West Semitic: 4; unexplained: 2; and Hurrian: 1.

Observing the part played by Hurrians in the highest circles of the Ugaritic society, the discovery of Hurrian literature and evidence of Hurrian religious ritual at Ugarit only confirms the dignity and prestige that the second largest community of that city enjoyed. They belonged to the ruling classes of their communities. The basic population of Syria proper had probably become West Semitic after the arrival of Amorites in the second millennium B.C., but Hurrians were possibly (some would say 'probably') indigenous in north Syria as in north Mesopotamia at least at the end of the third millennium B.C., but possibly earlier since the existence of Urkiš shows evidence of continuity.

A canonical list of 26 Hurrian deities is extracted from six tablets in alphabetic cuneiform, of which five were found in excellent condition during the 24th campaign at Ras Shamra – Ugarit, cf. E. Laroche, 'Notes sur le panthéon hourrite de Ras Shamra', *JAOS 88,2 (1968)*, 148-150. E. Laroche remarks (p. 150): "L'insertion de dieux 'cananéens' dans le panthéon A, celles de dieux 'hourittes' dans le panthéon P, sont un signe éclatant de syncrétisme théologique et de symbiose ethnique."

In the canonical Hurrian pantheon which he extracted from 6 parallel versions we observe a remarkable mixture of gods and goddesses of various origins.

Observing this list of gods worshipped by the Hurrians at Ugarit, one realizes that *El* is placed between two gods who play a most important part in Hurrian religion and ritual, the storm-god *Tešub* and *eni attanni* 'God the Father', whereas *Išḫara* is placed between *Tešub*'s spouse *Ḫebat* and another Hurrian goddess *Allani* 'the Lady', whose name can be explained as *Allai* 'lady' with the suffix of the definite article *-ni*.

One observes that in the list 50 % of the theonyms contain the so-called Hurrian article suffix *-n-* (12 times equated with singular *-ni-* in syllabic cuneiform, and one time equated with the plural *-na-*, namely *ḫdn-št ḫdlr-št* = *Ḫudena Ḫudellura* = déesses du destin, goddesses of destiny, also with the plural directive suffix *-št* = *-šta* in syllabic cuneiform).

The twelve deities in the singular form are (with the singular directive suffix *-d* = *-da* in syllabic cuneiform): *enšln-d* = *eni šalanni-da* = 'dieu le *šala*'; *enatn-d* = *eni atta-nni-da* = 'dieu le père'; *kmrb-n-d* = *Kumarbi-ni-da* = 'le Kumarbi'; *enardn-d* = *eni arde-ni-da* ? = ?; *enḫmn(n)-d* = *eni ḫumunni-da* = 'dieu Ḫumunni ?'; *šmgn-d* = *Šimegi-ni-da* = dieu 'le soleil'; *pžžpḫn-d* = *Pišašapḫi-ni-da* = 'le (dieu) de Piša(i)šapa'; *aln-d* = *Allani-da* = déesse 'la Dame'; *nwrw-n-d* = *Nawarwi-ni-da* = la (déesse) Nawarwi; *ağršḫ-n-d* = *aḫrušḫi-ni-da* = "l'encensoir"; *ḫbršḫ-n-d* = *ḫubrušḫi-ni-da* = "la terrine"; *kld-n-d* = *keldi-ni-da* = "la santé". E. Laroche, *GLH*, 54, s.v. *ardn*, writes: "Alph. *en-ardn-d*, dir. d'un nom divin composé *en-ardn*, *Ugar. V*, 525 n. 1 et 534. – *ardn* ne peut être *arde-ni* "la ville"; plutôt adj. épithète de *en* = *eni* 'dieu'."

E. Laroche's question mark after *enardn-d* = *eni arde-ni-da* is in accordance with his comment in *Glossaire de la langue hourrite*, 54, s.v. *arde* 'ville' and *ardn*: "Alph. *en-ardn-d*, dir. d'un nom divin composé *en-ardn*, *Ugar. V* 525, n. 1 et 534. – *ardn* ne peut être *arde-ni* 'la ville'; plutôt adj. épithète de *en* = *eni* 'dieu'." In *GLH*, 82-83, s.v. *eradi*, he adds: "La même mot que l'alph. *ard-n* ??" I consider E. Laroche's equation with *eradi* not necessary, since *en-ardn* may well be the '(Hurrian) patron god of the city of Ugarit'.

The list shows some lacunae at the top which can probably be completed with the names of three deities:

1. *enšln-d*	= *eni šalanni-da*	"dieu le šala (?)"
2. *enatn-d*	= *eni atta-nni-da*	"dieu le père"
3. *el-d*	= **Eli-da*	"El"

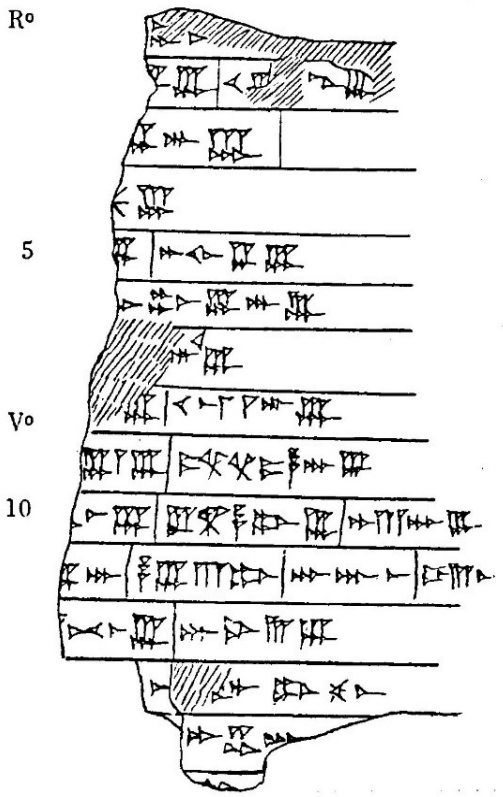
The first list is extracted from the Ugaritic texts in alphabetic cuneiform, the second shows the syllabic parallels as found mainly at Boğazköy, the third is the translation (cf. E. Laroche, 'Notes sur le panthéon hourrite de Ras Shamra', *JAOS 88,2 (1968)*, 148-150).

1. *enšln-d*	= *eni šalanni-da*	"dieu le šala (?)"
2. *enatn-d*	= *eni atta-nni-da*	"dieu le père"
3. *el-d*	= **Eli-da*	"El"
4. *tšb-d*	= *Tešub-da*	Tešub = Adad = Ba'al
5. *šušk-d*	= *Šauška-da*	Ištar
6. *kmrb-n-d*	= *Kumarbi-ni-da*	"le Kumarbi"
7. *kšǧ-d*	= *Kušuḫa-da*	dieu Lune
8. *ey-d*	= *Eya-da*	dieu Ea
9. *aštb-d*	= *Aštabi-da*	Aštabi dieu guerrier
10. *enardn-d*	= *eni arde-ni-da*	?
11. *enḫmn(n)-d*	= *eni ḫumunni-da*	dieu Ḫumunni ?
12. *ʿnt-d*	= *ʿAnata-da*	déesse ʿAnat
13. *šmgn-d*	= *Šimegi-ni-da*	dieu "le Soleil"
14. *nbdg-d*	= *Nubadiga-da*	dieu Nubadig
15. *pžžpḫn-d*	= *Pišašapḫi-ni-da*	(dieu) de Piša(i)šapa
16. *ḫbt-d*	= *Ḫebata-da*	déesse Ḫebat
17. *užḫr-d*	= *Ušḫara-da*	déesse Išḫara
18. *aln-d*	= *Allani-da*	déesse "la Dame"
19. *ḫdn-št ḫdlr-št*	= *Ḫudena-šta Ḫudellurra-šta*	déesses du destin
20. *nnt-d klt-d*	= *Ninatta-da Kulitta-da*	Ninatta et Kulitta
21. *dqt-d*	= *Dakita-da*	Dakiti, la "petite ?"
22. *adm-d kbb-d*	= *Adamma-da Kubaba-da*	Adamma et Kubaba
23. *nwrw-n-d*	= *Nawarwi-ni-da*	la (déesse) Nawarwi
24. *aǧršḫ-n-d*	= *aḫrusḫi-ni-da*	"l'encensoir"
25. *ḫbršḫ-n-d*	= *ḫubrušḫi-ni-da*	"la terrine"
26. *kld-n-d*	= *keldi-ni-da*	"la santé"

- the consonant *-d* at the end of most theonyms is the suffix *-da* of the dative-directive form , 'towards'/ 'for', equivalent to Semitic *l-*.
- *-št* is the dative-directive suffix *-šta* in the plural form.
- *-n-* is the suffix *-ni-* indicating the definite article (plural *-na-*).

The following drawing of the text of Ras Shamra 24.295 (cf. E. Laroche, 'Documents en langue hourrite provenant de Ras Shamra', *Ugaritica V (1968),* 508) provides a list of divinities in the alphabetic cuneiform of Ugarit. Apart from the suffix representing the definite article *-n* in the alphabetic cuneiform, which equals *-ni/-ne* in the cuneiform syllabary, the list also provides the suffix *-d* in alphabetic cuneiform, which equals */-da/* in the cuneiform syllabary (written *-ta* in single writing designating the voiced character of the dental occlusive).

LIST OF DIVINITIES: RS. 24.295



.....
2 [tš]bd
š[u]škd
3 [kmr]bnd
4 [kž]ǧd
5 [ey]d
aštbd
6 [en]ardnd
7 [en]ḫmnd
8 ['n]td
šmgnd
9 [nb]dgd
pžžpḫnd
10 [ḫb]td
užḫrd
alnd
11 [ḫ]dn.ḫdlr
nnt klt
12 [d]qtd
nkld
13]wršt
14]abn[

From: E. Laroche, *Ugaritica 5*, Paris 1968, 508

I do not share Laroche's hesitation to identify *ardn* with *arde-ni* 'the city', in *en-ardn-d*, because mentioning the abstract term 'the city' instead of the name of the city of Ugarit (Hurrian alphabetic *Ugrt*, CTA 175, 3; RS 24.285, 9. – Gen. *Ugrt-w = Ugarit(i)-we*, RS 24.274, 7; *Ugar. V*, 505, cf. E. Laroche, *GLH*, 277) may be explained as a means to pay respect to the City-god, just as *eni attanni* is a respectful way of avoiding to mention the real name of the God. Interpretation of *enardn-d = eni arde-ni-da* as '(Patron) god of the City of Ugarit' seems in my view preferable.

The theonym ***Kumarbi*** has been connected with the verbal root ***kum-*** 'errichten, auftürmen' ['to build / erect / pile up'] and has been interpreted as ***kum=ar=we*** '(der) des Errichtens / Auftürmens' ['(the one) of building > active as a builder'] or '(quello) di Kumar' ['(the one) of (toponym) Kumar'], cf. Th. Richter, *BGH*, 221-222, s.v. ***kum-*** [EN; Nuzi]. Both etymologies are possible, but in my view not very satisfactory.

To me it seems more attractive to interpret ***-bi*** or ***-wi*** in ***Kumarbi / Kumarwi*** not as the genitive suffix ***-bi / -wi***, but as part of the Nuzian variant ***erwi*** (as a result of metathesis) of ***ibri / iwri / ebri / ewri*** 'Lord', so that the meaning of ***Kumarbi/wi < *Kum(m)a-erwi*** (as a result of contraction) is 'Lord of *Kumma*' and that of ***Kumarbi=ni*** is 'The Lord of Kumma'. The variant ***erwi*** may not be limited to Nuzi. In this way the etymology of *Kumarbi* contributes to a better understanding of the mythological struggle between *Kumarbi* as 'Lord of Kumma' and his son *Tešub* who conquered (and mutilated) his father, but also succeeded him as new Lord of Kumma and is therefore called ***Kummeni***, cf. E. Laroche, *GLH*, 154, s.v. ***Kummeni***: Épithète de Tešub. ^{d}U-*ub* ^{uru}*Arraphi-ni* ^{uru}*Kum-me-ni*, KBo XX 128, 8 = XXII 165, 14; cf. KUB XXV 47 I 7 = XXXII 44 Vo 9; *Tešuba(m) ku-um-me-ni-en*, Mâri 1, 34; - Hitt. ^{uru}*Kummiyas* ^{d}U-*as* 'Tešub de Kummi'. Gén. *alla-ni Ku-um-me-ni-we*, litt. 'la dame de Kummi' (Ḫebat ?), RS h. 10, 4 = *Ugar. V* 467,

It is interesting that apart from possible Semitic names such as *Ḫy3n* (= possibly Semitic *Ḫyrn*) among names of the Hyksos rulers in Egypt, and names of so far unidentified origin, at least one Hurrian name has been identified by W.A. Ward, 'Some personal names of the Hyksos period rulers and notes on the epigraphy of their scarabs', *UF 8 (1976),* 353-369. This name is found on a cylinder seal in University College London, now dated to the Second Intermediate period in Egypt. Ward states that the correct reading of the name is *K3-n-d-y,* a consonantal structure which immediately suggests a non-Semitic and non-Egyptian original.

The name *Kuntuya* (*Ku-un-du-ú-i*[*a*]) found at Nuzi (cf. *NPN*, 91 and 230) and very likely of Hurrian origin would be an excellent cognate. Prior to the discovery of the Nuzi archives K. Tallqvist, *Assyrian personal names*, Helsingfors 1941, 118, 290, suggested an other etymology, as he felt that the similar name *Kundaya* might be related to the Anatolian toponym *Kundi* or to the element *kñta* in Lycian names (cf. J. Sundwall, *ENL,* 111). The Hurrian derivation is probably the better one and would thus bear out E.A. Speiser's contention that there were Hurrian elements among the Hyksos rulers and their followers (cf. E.A. Speiser, 'Ethnic movements in the Near East in the second millenium B.C. - The Hurrians and their connections with the *Ḫabiru* and the Hyksos', *AASOR 13 (1931-1932)*, 26-27 and note 54). With respect to Egyptian orthography Ward remarks that the group *k3* is frequently written where a foreign original shows the syllable *ku* (cf. *op. cit.*, 363).

The term ‘Hyksos’ used by Manetho is derived from Egyptian *Hikau-khoswet* ‘Rulers of Foreign Countries’ or ‘Princes of the Desert Uplands’, signifying the bedouin princes of Syria and Palestine as early as the first half of the 12th Dynasty, but also the chieftains of Nubia as far back as the late Old Kingdom. In the Second Intermediate Period they comprised the intruders of ‘Amu’, ‘Setjetiu’, ‘Mentjiu [of] Setjet’, men of ‘Retenu’, the same Asiatic people who had harassed the north-east border for a long time and who had already overrun the Nile delta during the First Intermediate Period (cf. W.C. Hayes, ‘The Hyksos infiltration and the founding of the Fifteenth Dynasty’, *CAH II, Part 1, Chapter II*, 54-55). Interesting is the name of the Hyksos capital *Avaris / Auaris* (Egyptian: *ḥw-t wr-t*, *Hut-waret*; Greek: *Αὔαρις*) in the eastern Nile delta. Either the name is originally Egyptian and might mean ‘Great house’ in Egyptian, referring to the palace and administrative centre, or *Avaris / Auaris / Αὔαρις* represents the actual ancient name of the capital of the intruding foreigners, which might etymologically be derived from Hurrian *a-wa-ri* ‘field’, ‘steppe’, cf. E. Laroche, *Glossaire de la langue hourrite, RHA 34-35 (1976-1977)*, 65 s.v. *a-wa-ri* ‘champ’, ‘steppe’.

The term *a-wa-ri* is found *passim* at Boğazköy, Ugarit and Nuzi and finds its parallels in Sumerian EDIN and Akkadian *eqlu*. In this case it might designate the flat plain of the Nile delta at the site of modern Tell el-Dab’a, where the ruling Asiatic Hyksos founded their residence to lodge a large army guarding the east border of Egypt and to build a temple for Seth, equated with Ba’al and Tešub. Frescos with scenes of bulls and especially of a bull-leaping athlete found at Avaris / Tell el-Dab’a in Egypt are so similar to those known from Minoan Crete and Syria that a relation seems evident, but it remains as yet difficult to interpret the exact implications of this relationship, because there is still too little known about the composition of the Hyksos population and their rulers. It is assumed that they came from Syria and Palestine with their mixed population. But was their arrival spontaneous or caused by outside forces from the north, possibly pressure caused by the expansion of Mitanni ?

G. Wilhelm (*Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter*, 1) has proposed an attractive etymology for the name of the Hurrians. He suggests a connection with *ḫuradi* ‘Wachsoldat’ [‘guardian soldier’], attested in both Hurrian and Urartian, as well as in later Akkadian, especially in Assyrian [I translate his German text]: “In this case one must segment the suffix *-(a)di* that also occurs in other descriptions of persons. A root *Ḫur-* that belongs semantically to the sphere and status of warriors is conceivable as meaning of an ethnic.

Ultimately one may refer to the guardian bull *Ḫurri* of the Hurrian Weather God *Teš(š)ub* as well as a town *Ḫurra* in the Hurrian lands (cf. E.A. Speiser, *IH*, 1941: 4).”

Ḫurri is mentioned, with *Šerri* and *Tilla*, as one of the bulls guarding Tešub in Akkadian and Hittite texts: ^{gud}*ḫu-(u)-ur-ri,* ^{d}*ḫu-(u)-ur-ri* KBo I 1 Vo 41; KBo VI 28+Vo 32; KUB XXI 1 IV 8; XVII 14 I 10; XXXIII 97 I 12, – Msk. ^{d}*Ḫu-ur-ra.* H.: *Šerri Ḫu-ur-ri* GUD^{ḫia}*-ri*, KBo XX 119 I 15, IV 26 = KBo XVII 86+ I 4. Onom. *Ari-b-Ḫurra*, *NPN*, 218 (cf. Laroche, *GLH*, 115).

According to I. Wegner (*Einführung in die hurritische Sprache*, 21) presence of Hurrians and Hurrian in the Near East is attested in written documents from the Akkade-period (2230-2090 B.C. in the short chronology and otherwise 6o years earlier) until ca. 1200 B.C. Subsequently Hurrians were still present in pockets in east Anatolia.

Presumably Hurrian has already been present in north Iraq and east Anatolia considerably earlier, since the form ***ta/ibira*** 'copper-worker', for which a plausible Hurrian derivation can be given, occurs in Old Sumerian texts. Hurrian ***ta-bi-ri-i-ma*** is also attested in the Hurrian-Hittite bilingual ***Kirenze***, KBo 32: 14 Vs. I 46 (cf. E. Neu, *StBoT 32*, 80), in the 3rd parable: *The goblet (chalice, cup) and its smith* (KBo 32: 14 Vs. I 42-59). I. Wegner (*Einführung*, 21, 217-218) analyses the form as ***tab=i=ri=ma***, consisting of the verbal root ***tab/v-*** 'to cast (metal)' + ***i*** (vowel indicating transitivity) + ***ri/e*** (participial suffix) 'der gegossen hat = Gießer = Schmied' ['the one who has cast (metal); smith'] + the enclitic particle ***ma*** 'and'. The forms in ***=i=ri/e*** are 'agent oriented resultative participles'.

For students of cultural interrelations between the Near East and Crete G. Wilhelm provides interesting information, *op. cit.*, 112 (cf. his Abb.2) [I translate his German text]: "In the 15th century B.C. an original type of pottery appears in the Near East. Its area of distribution approximately corresponds with the Empire of Mitanni in the wider sense, i.e. including the vassal states in east and west. Both form and decoration are characteristic for this pottery. Most cups and pots are slender and have a small base, often in the form of a bud. The decoration in white paint on a dark – red-brown to black – background shows geometric (spirals, triangles, 'running dogs', interlaced strings, zigzag-lines) and naturalistic motives (birds, goats, palmettes). This so-called 'Nuzi ware' first occurs at Nuzi and in layer IV at Alalaḫ and continues to the end of the 13th century, i.e. long after the end of the Empire of Mitanni. During the later phases the 'Açana ware', called after the modern name of Alalaḫ, develops from the 'Nuzi ware'. It is distinguished by a particularly elegant floral decoration. The combination of colours as well as certain motives, especially of the 'Açana ware', but also already the 'Nuzi ware', remind us of the Cretan Palace style, that certainly flourished a considerable time before the beginning the 'Nuzi ware' (Hrouda 1957, Cecchini 1965)."

There are two reasons to emphasize that comparisons of Cretan art with that of the Near East can in no way be used as evidence for any proposal with regard to the identification of the idiom written with Linear A.

1. The area concerned in the Near East had a population of a mixed and heterogeneous composition so that it is very difficult to assign any form of art to a particular group of people (cf. A.B. Knapp and A. Marchant, 'Cyprus, Cypro-Minoan and Hurrians', *Report Department of Antiquities, University of California at Berkeley (=RDAC)* 1982, 15-30).

2. The adoption of a script or the introduction of a new language or idiom is often found to take place along lines other than the transference or inheritance of forms of art which can be influenced by fashion, trade and other forms of contact.

Decipherment of a script should primarily be based on linguistic evidence, i.e. clearly recognizable features of phonology, morphology and syntax of the idiom written with that script. It is, of course, welcome, if archaeological evidence does not contradict, but support the results of linguistic research. Therefore I hesitate to mention comparisons at all.

From: G. Wilhelm, *Grundzüge der Geschichte und Kultur der Hurriter,* Darmstadt 1982, 111, Abb. 2. Drawings: Cecchini 1965.
At the top: examples of ‘Nuzi ware’.
In the middle: vases from Tall Brāk.
Below: examples of ‘Açana ware’ from Alalaḫ.